Which AI Tool for What?

A quick, plain-language comparison of four popular AI assistants. **As of October 2026** - features and limits change often, so check each official site for current details.

	ChatGPT (OpenAI)	Gemini (Google)	Claude (Anthropic)	Microsoft Copilot
Free version?	Yes - with usage limits	Yes - with usage limits	Yes - with usage limits	Yes - with usage limits
Paid plans add	More usage, advanced models & features	More usage, models, Google app features & storage	More usage, more models & tools	Bundled with Microsoft 365 plans; more usage & features
Voice conversation	Yes (limited on free)	Yes (Gemini Live)	Yes (voice mode)	Yes
Web search	Yes*	Yes*	Yes	Yes*
Image creation	Yes (limited on free)	Yes	Not its focus	Yes
Works best with	General all-rounder; large ecosystem	Google account & Search; Gmail/Docs need a paid plan	Long documents, careful writing & reasoning	Windows & Edge; Word/Excel/Outlook need paid Microsoft 365
Good first pick for	Everyday questions, brainstorming, learning	People who live in Google apps	Writing, editing, summarizing long text	Microsoft 365 users at home or work

By task - try these first

Task	Strong options	Tip
Explain a topic simply	Any of the four	Ask: "Explain like I'm new to this."
Write or polish an email/letter	Claude, ChatGPT, Copilot chat; Copilot in Outlook (paid)	Paste your draft and say the tone you want.
Summarize a long document	Claude, Gemini, ChatGPT (file uploads limited on free plans)	Upload the file; ask for 5 bullet points.
Plan a trip or schedule	Gemini, ChatGPT	Give dates, budget and must-sees.
Create a picture	ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot	Describe subject, style, colors.
Spreadsheet help	ChatGPT or any chat; Copilot in Excel (paid); Gemini in Sheets (paid)	Describe columns; ask for the formula.
Current news & facts	Any, with web search on	Always open and check the sources.

(paid) = needs a paid plan as of Oct 2026. * Web search availability can vary by plan, country and setting.
Always: double-check important facts, never share passwords or ID/bank numbers, and review each service's privacy settings. Availability varies by country, age and device.
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Prompt-Writing Desk Card

Print at 100% (no scaling), cut along the dashed lines and fold or glue back-to-back. Card size: 5.5 x 3.6 in - a desk-friendly size that fits most small frames and card holders.

✂ cut along dashed line

Write Better Prompts: R-T-C-F + Refine

R	**Role**	Who should the AI act as? e.g. "Act as a friendly travel planner."
T	**Task**	What exactly do you want? e.g. "Plan a 3-day city break."
C	**Context**	Details that matter. e.g. "Two adults, mid-range budget, love food markets."
F	**Format**	How should the answer look? e.g. "A day-by-day table, under 200 words."
+	**Refine**	Follow up to improve it. e.g. "Make day 2 more relaxed."

✂ cut along dashed line

Example: putting it together

"**Act as** a patient tutor. **Explain** how compound interest works **for** someone who has never invested, using one simple example with round numbers. **Format:** 5 short bullet points, then a one-line summary."

Quick refine phrases

- "Shorter, please."
- "Explain step by step."
- "Ask me questions first."
- "Give me 3 options."
- "What did you assume?"
- "Rewrite in a warmer tone."

Check facts. Never share passwords or ID numbers. Works with any chat assistant.